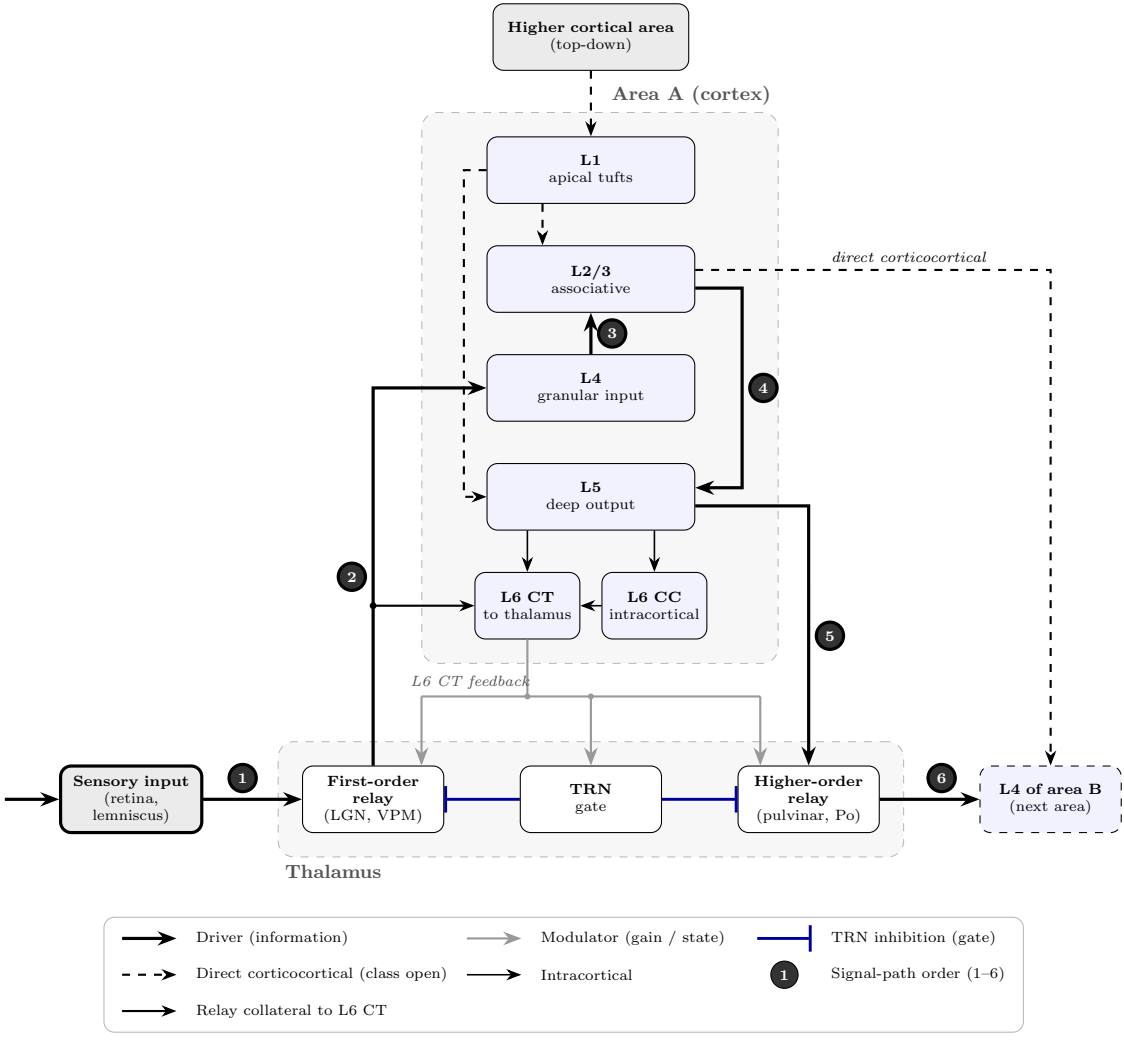

Higher cortical area
(top-down)
Area A (cortex)
L1
apical tufts
L2/3
associative
direct corticocortical
3
L4
granular input
4
L5
deep output
2
L6 CT
to thalamus
L6 CC
intracortical
5
L6 CT feedback
Sensory input
(retina,
lemniscus)
1
First-order
relay
(LGN, VPM)
TRN
gate
Higher-order
relay
(pulvinar, Po)
6
L4 of area B
(next area)
Thalamus
Driver (information)
Modulator (gain / state)
TRN inhibition (gate)
Direct corticocortical (class open)
Intracortical
1
Signal-path order (1–6)
Relay collateral to L6 CT